

Ending Well

Twelve weeks, and the men who walked them with you. This is where you tell them where you started, what changed, what God did, and what you hope for — in your own words, one line at a time. Each line starts for you; you finish it.

This sheet carries the same questions as the page, for working away from a screen. When you are ready, type your lines into Ending Well in Week 12 so it is saved to your page.

Part 1 of 6 — The Doorway

The course's last charge was "stay with the men you walked with." This is where you say it to them.

Twelve weeks. Say the first true word. The row of words is there if you need it. Then say why, in a few words.

Finish the line. For example: To the men I walked with, I am tired and grateful. You heard the worst of it and you kept showing up.

Words to choose from: thankful · grateful · sad · still struggling with · hopeful

To the men I walked with, I am ...

What did they see that nobody else did? One picture.

Finish the line. For example: You saw me on the Wednesday I almost didn't log on.

You saw me ...

Part 2 of 6 — Where I started

Week 1 was The Enemy Knows You — "he's a person who has studied you your whole life." Where were you when you read that? A picture a man could see, not a label.

Finish the line. For example: When I started, I was sitting in the truck in the driveway, not ready to go in the house.

When I started, I was ...

The sentence you were living on. Short.

Finish the line. For example: What I told myself was that I had it handled.

What I told myself was ...

The part no one could see from outside.

Finish the line. For example: What nobody knew was how long it had been going on.

What nobody knew was ...

Part 3 of 6 — What changed

Not twelve weeks. What is different in you, in three places: body, soul, spirit.

Week 1 called it your Sphere of Influence: “any sound, sight, smell, or touch, you control.” And: “The enemy has had free rein inside your SOI, and he’s been bringing his trash in with him.” What was coming in?

Finish the line. For example: What came in through my eyes and ears was a screen at midnight and voices telling me I was the only one.

What came in through my eyes and ears was ...

Same sphere, your hands on the gate now. What do you let in?

Finish the line. For example: What I take in now is a walk before the house wakes up and a chapter of John read out loud.

What I take in now is ...

Be transformed by the renewal of your mind — Romans 12:2

A word, a relationship, a habit of thought. What is being made new?

Finish the line. For example: What is being renewed in me is the word “father” — it used to mean absence.

What is being renewed in me is ...

So now faith, hope, and love abide, these three — 1 Corinthians 13:13

Spirit is relationship. Which one grew, and what does it look like?

Finish the line. For example: Between me and God, what is growing is hope. I expect him to show up now.

Words to choose from: faith · hope · love

Between me and God, what is growing is ...

Part 4 of 6 — What God did

I will turn their mourning into joy; I will comfort them, and give them gladness for sorrow. — Jeremiah 31:13

If it is still quiet and the struggle is still here, say that. It is not failure. This takes years, not weeks, and God's answer may be as small as a room with men in it.

What did you ask God for at the start? Say it the way you said it then. Not every ask is answered yet.

Finish the line. For example: I asked him for it to stop.

I asked him for ...

One true sentence. For some men it is this: there are men willing to walk with me. That is God offering relationship.

Finish the line. For example: What God did was put me in a room with men willing to walk with me.

What God did was ...

Years, not weeks. One step you can take this month.

Finish the line. For example: The small step I can grow by is showing up next Wednesday, whatever this week was.

The small step I can grow by is ...

Part 5 of 6 — My hope for the future

Week 12 says “orientation was always the trailhead, not the destination.” A year down the trail — what do you want to be true?

Finish the line. For example: My hope for the future is to be a man my kids can tell the truth to.

My hope for the future is ...

The Wednesdays are done. What do you need from these men now?

Finish the line. For example: What I ask of you is to keep asking me the question, even when I say I'm fine.

What I ask of you is ...

Yes or no — say it plainly and own it. Both are honorable. A goodbye said well is an ending done right.

Finish the line. For example: Going forward, with this group, I will say goodbye. Thank you. I am taking this with me.

Words to choose from: stay · say goodbye

Going forward, with this group, I will ...

Week 12: “The days are not the achievement. Whatever you did that made the days is the achievement. Find it, name it out loud in the room, and do it again.” Pick one, or write your own.

Finish the line. For example: When the gaps get longer and voices fade, I will remember by a call on the first of the month.

Words to choose from: a call · a text · coffee · an online meeting

When the gaps get longer and voices fade, I will remember by ...

Part 6 of 6 — Set a stone

A stone is what you set so you can find the way again. Choose yours: one of your own lines above, or the words you walk by.

Or your own words.

Your own words. For example: Do the next right thing.

Or tap one of your own lines from What God did when you type this into the page.

